

SERVING THE 1962 ROMAN MISSAL

LOW MASS

TRAINER MANUAL

Page-aligned coaching for the child field guide

Hear the cue. Say the response. Make the movement.

A black-and-white training aid for two young servers.

Follow the priest and the customs taught for your church. This is not an official liturgical book.

Follow the priest and the customs taught for your church. See the terminal appendices for preparation, local choices, scope, and sources.

ARRIVE AND KNEEL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 2

TRAINER

ARRIVAL

Fix the actual doorway and reverence before rehearsal. The diagram deliberately does not depict genuflection.

BIRETTA

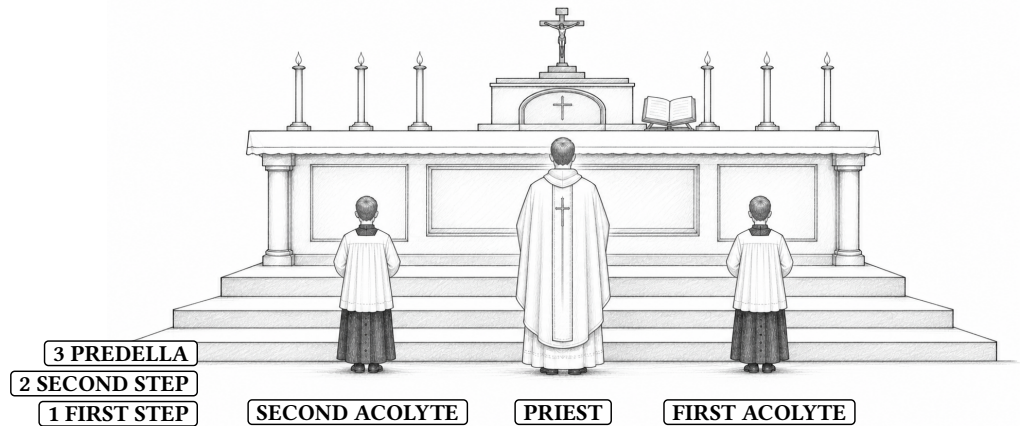
If the priest wears one, First receives and places it at the location fixed before Mass. Keep this out of a first rehearsal.

WATCH

Standing heads are clearly higher; kneeling figures show two knees on the floor and tucked feet.

First stays on the priest's right. Second stays on his left. The priest needs the centre.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



1

WHO BOTH

DO: Process shoulder to shoulder.

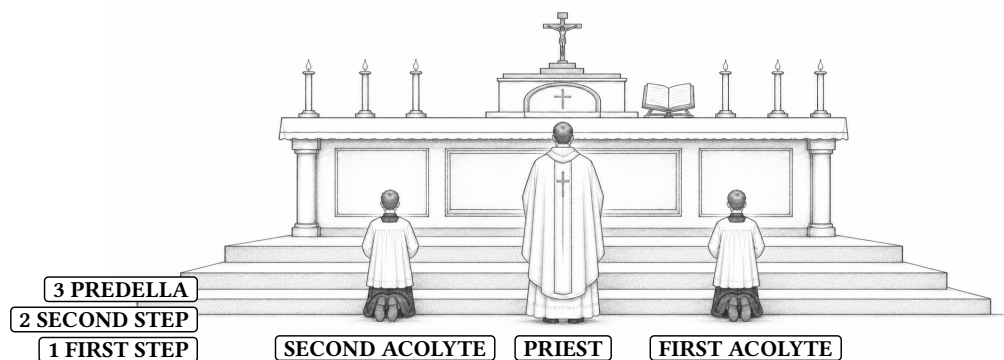
HOW / FINISH: First is picture-right; Second is picture-left. Stop at the foot and leave room for the priest.

2

WHO BOTH

DO: Make the taught reverence.

HOW / FINISH: Remain standing while the priest places the chalice, opens the Missal, and returns to the foot.



When the priest begins the prayers, lower together onto **both knees on the sanctuary floor**.

BEGIN THE PRAYERS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 3
TRAINER

PACE
First sets a moderate pace.
Second begins and finishes
with First; neither races the
other.

BEFORE 01
Both sign with the priest at
In nomine Patris. His *Amen*
completes the formula; add
none.

BRANCH
At a Mass of the season from
Passion Sunday through
Holy Thursday, keep 01, omit
Psalm 42, and continue at 06.

Both acolytes are kneeling on the sanctuary floor at the foot. Read across each numbered row.

MASS OF THE SEASON, PASSION SUNDAY THROUGH HOLY THURSDAY

Say 01, omit 02–05 and the repeated 01, and continue at 06. Otherwise continue with Psalm 42 below.

TRAINER / PRIEST	SERVER
01 PRIEST <i>Introibo ad altare Dei.</i>	BOTH Ad Deum qui laetificat iuventutem meam. SAY IT ahd DEH-oom kwee leh-TEE-fee-kaht yoo-vehn-TOO-tehm MEH-ahm
02 PRIEST <i>Iudica me, Deus, et discerne causam meam de gente non sancta: ab homine iniquo, et doloso erue me.</i>	BOTH Quia tu es, Deus, fortitudo mea: quare me repulisti, et quare tristis incedo, dum affligit me inimicus? SAY IT KWEE-ah too ehs, DEH-oos, for-tee-TOO-doh MEH-ah: KWAH-reh meh reh-poo-LEE-stee, eht KWAH-reh TREES-tees een-CHEH-doh, doom ahf-FLEE-jeet meh ee-nee-MEE-koos?
03 PRIEST <i>Emitte lucem tuam, et veritatem tuam: ipsa me deduxerunt, et adduxerunt in montem sanctum tuum, et in tabernacula tua.</i>	BOTH Et introibo ad altare Dei: ad Deum qui laetificat iuventutem meam. SAY IT eht een-troh-EE-boh ahd ahl-TAH-reh DEH-ee: ahd DEH-oom kwee leh-TEE-fee-kaht yoo-vehn-TOO-tehm MEH-ahm

Reading key: capital letters in the sound line mark the stressed syllable. Say every syllable; the sound line and meaning are practice helps, never words added at Mass.

FINISH PSALM 42

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 4

TRAINER

MEANING

Use the short meanings to keep the verse chain from becoming unconnected sounds. They are not translations to recite.

GESTURE

Bow at the priest's *Gloria Patri*. Sign together at *Adiutorium nostrum*.

OMISSION

When Psalm 42 is omitted, turn directly from 01 to 06; do not use 02–05 or the repeated 01.

The priest speaks one complete verse. Both answer with the next complete verse.

IF PSALM 42 IS OMITTED

Do not use 02–05 or the repeated 01. Continue directly at 06.

TRAINER / PRIEST

SERVER

04 PRIEST

*Confitebor tibi in cithara, Deus,
Deus meus: quare tristis es, anima
mea, et quare conturbas me?*

BOTH

**Spera in Deo, quoniam adhuc
confitebor illi: salutare vultus
mei, et Deus meus.**

SAY IT

SPEH-rah een DEH-oh, KWOH-nee-ahm
AHD-ook kohn-fee-TEH-bor EEL-lee:
sah-loo-TAH-reh VOOL-toos MEH-ee,
eht DEH-oos MEH-oos

05 PRIEST

*Gloria Patri, et Filio, et Spiritui
Sancto.*

BOTH

**Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et
semper: et in saecula saeculorum.
Amen.**

SAY IT

SEE-koot EH-raht een
preen-CHEE-pee-oh, eht noonk, eht
SEHM-pehr: eht een SEH-koo-lah
seh-koo-LOH-room. AH-mehn

01 PRIEST

AGAIN

Introibo ad altare Dei.

BOTH

**Ad Deum qui laetificat
iuventutem meam.**

06 PRIEST

*Adiutorium nostrum in nomine
Domini.*

BOTH

Qui fecit caelum et terram.

SAY IT

kwee FEH-cheet CHEH-loom eht
TEHR-rahm

ANSWER THE PRIEST’S CONFITEOR

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 5

TRAINER

CUE
Practise the complete final sentence, not only *Dominum Deum nostrum*.

DIRECTION
Both turn and make the taught bow toward the priest while speaking to him.

NUMBER
The singular words *tui* and *tuis* address one priest.

Listen through the priest’s complete Confiteor. His final sentence is the cue.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
07	PRIEST <i>Ideo precor beatam Mariam semper Virginem, beatum Michaellem Archangelum, beatum Ioannem Baptistam, sanctos Apostolos Petrum et Paulum, omnes Sanctos, et vos, fratres, orare pro me ad Dominum Deum nostrum.</i>	BOTH Misereatur tui omnipotens Deus, et, dimissis peccatis tuis, perducate ad vitam aeternam. SAY IT mee-seh-reh-AH-toor TOO-ee ohm-NEE-poh-tehns DEH-oos, eht, dee-MEES-sees pehk-KAH-tees TOO-ees, pehr-DOO-kaht teh ahd VEE-tahm eh-TEHR-nahm
1	WHO BOTH DO: Turn and bow toward the priest. HOW / FINISH: Say the whole response together. The priest answers <i>Amen</i>. Remain bowed and begin your Confiteor on the next page.	

YOUR CONFITEOR · PART 1

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 6

TRAINER

ONE PRAYER

The three pages divide one complete response for learning. Do not insert a pause at the page turns once it is learned.

TURN

At *et tibi, pater*, both turn toward the priest, then face the altar again.

DECK

The full Confiteor is intentionally absent from the fixed-size eight-up flash cards; shrinking it would recreate the tested clutter problem.

Both remain bowed. Learn one sense-sized part at a time, then join all three parts without stopping.

PART 1 · I CONFESS

Confiteor Deo omnipotenti, beatae Mariae semper Virgini, beato Michaeli Archangelo, beato Ioanni Baptistae, sanctis Apostolis Petro et Paulo, omnibus Sanctis, et tibi, pater:

SAY IT

kohn-FEE-teh-or DEH-oh ohm-nee-poh-TEHN-tee, beh-AH-teh mah-REE-eh SEHM-pehr
VEER-jee-nee, beh-AH-toh mee-kah-EH-lee ahr-KAHN-jeh-loh, beh-AH-toh
yoh-AHN-nee bahp-TEES-teh, SAHNK-tees ah-POHS-toh-lees PEH-troh eht POW-loh,
OHM-nee-boos SAHNK-tees, eht TEE-bee, PAH-tehr

1

WHO BOTH

DO: Keep the prayer moving.

HOW / FINISH: At the colon after *pater*, continue directly to Part 2.

YOUR CONFITEOR · PART 2

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 7

TRAINER

BREAST

At each *mea culpa*, both strike the breast once with the right hand.

ENDINGS

Correct the Latin word endings before increasing speed.

JOIN

Begin at Part 1, continue through this page, then turn immediately to Part 3.

Part 2 begins with the reason for the confession and starts the petition for prayer.

PART 2 · BECAUSE I SINNED

quia peccavi nimis cogitatione, verbo et opere: mea culpa, mea culpa, mea maxima culpa. Ideo precor beatam Mariam semper Virginem,

SAY IT

KWEE-ah pehk-KAH-vee NEE-mees koh-jee-tah-tsee-OH-neh, VEHR-boh eht OH-peh-reh: MEH-ah KOOL-pah, MEH-ah KOOL-pah, MEH-ah MAHK-see-mah KOOL-pah. EE-deh-oh PREH-kor beh-AH-tahm mah-REE-ahm SEHM-pehr VEER-jee-nehm

2

WHO BOTH

DO: Strike three times.

HOW / FINISH: Strike once at each *mea culpa*. Keep the other hand over the breast.

FOOT/ALTAR

YOUR CONFITEOR · PART 3

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 7

TRAINER

TURN

At *et te, pater*, both turn toward the priest, then finish still bowed.

WHOLE RUN

Once each part is secure, start at *Confiteor Deo* and finish at *Deum nostrum* without a prompt.

NEXT

The priest now says *Misereatur vestri*; both remain bowed for the first Amen.

Part 3 completes the petition. This is the end of the one full Confiteor begun on page 9.

PART 3 · PLEASE PRAY FOR ME

beatum Michaellem Archangelum, beatum Ioannem Baptistam, sanctos Apostolos Petrum et Paulum, omnes Sanctos, et te, pater, orare pro me ad Dominum Deum nostrum.

SAY IT

beh-AH-toom mee-kah-EH-lehm ahr-KAHN-jeh-loom, beh-AH-toom yoh-AHN-nehm bahp-TEES-tahm, SAHNK-tohs ah-POHS-toh-lohs PEH-troom eht POW-loom, OHM-nehs SAHNK-tohs, eht teh, PAH-tehr, oh-RAH-reh proh meh ahd DOH-mee-noom DEH-oom NOHS-troom

3

WHO BOTH

DO: Finish together.

HOW / FINISH: Stay bowed after *Dominum Deum nostrum*. Listen for the priest's next prayer.

RECEIVE THE ABSOLUTION PRAYERS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 8

TRAINER

POSTURE

Both remain bowed through the first Amen. At *Indulgentiam*, rise upright and sign with the priest.

AMEN

This is the first taught Amen. Use the same complete word at later audible prayer endings.

NO EXTRA

Do not carry this Amen backward to the opening Sign of the Cross.

The priest says two prayers. Both answer *Amen* after each.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
08	PRIEST <i>Misereatur vestri omnipotens Deus, et, dimissis peccatis vestris, perducatur vos ad vitam aeternam.</i>	BOTH Amen. SAY IT AH-mehn
08 AGAIN	PRIEST <i>Indulgentiam, absolutionem et remissionem peccatorum nostrorum tribuat nobis omnipotens et misericors Dominus.</i>	BOTH Amen.
09	PRIEST <i>Deus, tu conversus vivificabis nos.</i>	BOTH Et plebs tua laetabitur in te. SAY IT eht plehbs TOO-ah leh-TAH-bee-toor een teh

FINISH AT THE FOOT

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 9

TRAINER

BOW

Both make the taught simple bow through the three short versicles, then raise their heads at *Oremus*.

ALB

If the local route assigns it, both assist the priest’s alb as he ascends.

TRANSITION

After *Oremus*, stand and move directly to the normal places shown on the next page.

Stay together through the three short answers and the greeting.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
10	PRIEST <i>Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam.</i>	BOTH Et salutare tuum da nobis. SAY IT eht sah-loo-TAH-reh TOO-oom dah NOH-bees
11	PRIEST <i>Domine, exaudi orationem meam.</i>	BOTH Et clamor meus ad te veniat. SAY IT eht KLAH-mor MEH-oos ahd teh VEH-nee-aht
12	PRIEST <i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	BOTH Et cum spiritu tuo. SAY IT eht koom SPEE-ree-too TOO-oh

MOVE TO THE NORMAL PLACES

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 10

TRAINER

CUE

At the priest's *Oremus*, both raise their heads. First cues the rise after the priest has begun ascending.

LEVEL

The model normal places are on the first step, one level below the priest. Map that rule to the actual sanctuary.

INTROIT

Both sign with the priest at his opening sign and make the taught head bow at *Gloria Patri*.

Stand, turn inward, and go to the two outside normal places. Kneel together on the first step.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



Normal places: Second at the Gospel side, picture-left; First at the Epistle side, picture-right. Both are **kneeling on the first step**.

1

WHO BOTH

DO: Stay at the normal places.

HOW / FINISH: Remain kneeling for the Introit, Kyrie, Gloria when appointed, Collect, and Epistle. No server response is added during the Introit or Gloria.

READINGS

SAY THE NINE KYRIES

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 10

TRAINER

PATTERN

Low Mass uses three groups of three. Both acolytes speak every server position together.

CARDS

Flash cards 13 and 14 teach the two priest-to-server pair types; only this page shows who begins each group.

GLORIA

If the Gloria follows, remain kneeling and make only the gestures taught locally; there is no short server response.

The priest and both acolytes alternate. Do not turn the two *Christe* server places into priest cues.

GROUP 1 · KYRIE

Priest: *Kyrie, eleison.* **Both: Kyrie, eleison.** Priest: *Kyrie, eleison.*

GROUP 2 · CHRISTE

Both: Christe, eleison. Priest: *Christe, eleison.* **Both: Christe, eleison.**

GROUP 3 · KYRIE

Priest: *Kyrie, eleison.* **Both: Kyrie, eleison.** Priest: *Kyrie, eleison.*

SAY IT

KEE-ree-eh, eh-LEH-ee-sohn. KREES-teh, eh-LEH-ee-sohn.

MEANING

Lord, have mercy. Christ, have mercy.

COLLECT AND EPISTLE

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 11

TRAINER

COLLECTS

Answer Amen at the audible ending of each appointed Collect.

LESSONS

On days with several lessons, answer only where the proper sheet appoints it; move the Missal only after the final lesson.

EXAMPLE

The complete Epistle cue is a verified exemplar from the Fifth Sunday after Pentecost, not the ending for every day.

Remain kneeling. The first two responses are repeats. Card 15 uses one complete Epistle ending for practice.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
12	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	Et cum spiritu tuo.
08	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Per omnia saecula saeculorum.</i>	Amen.
15	PRIEST	BOTH
	<i>Dominum autem Christum sanctificate in cordibus vestris.</i>	Deo gratias.
		SAY IT
		DEH-oh GRAH-tsee-ahs

MOVE THE MISSAL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 12

TRAINER

SIGNAL

First waits until the priest has cleared the book. Never reach around him or pull the stand by its front edge.

PATH

First carries the stand down the short way, makes the taught centre reverence, and ascends the Gospel side.

NEXT MEANINGS

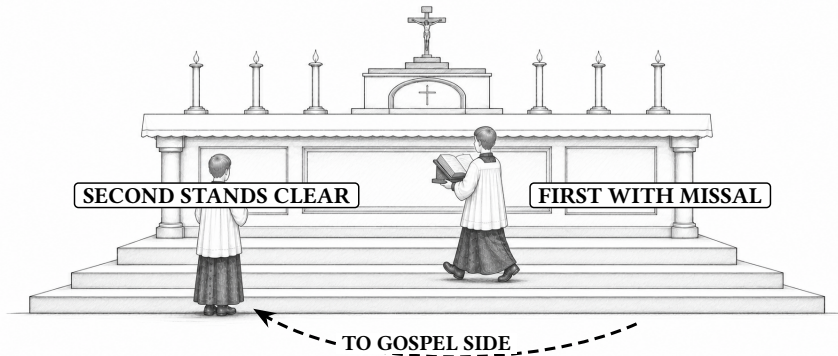
Gloria tibi, Domine: Glory to you, O Lord. *Laus tibi, Christe:* Praise to you, O Christ.

CLEAR LANE

Second stays at the Gospel normal place and steps back. First places the Missal angled toward the priest.

After the final *Deo gratias*, both stand. Second stays at the Gospel normal place and clears the lane. First moves the Missal.

OUR REHEARSED MODEL: This guide assigns the Epistle-to-Gospel book move to First. Other sound manuals assign it differently; do not mix the two plans.



STOP AT THE CENTRE. Make the exact reverence rehearsed for this altar while keeping a secure two-handed hold. Then continue.



At the Gospel title, First stands on the **second step** near the book. Second stands clear on the first step.

ANSWER AT THE GOSPEL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 13

TRAINER

TIMING

Both say *Laus tibi, Christe* as soon as the reading ends; do not wait for the priest to kiss the Missal.

CROSSES

At the title, both make the three small crosses with the priest: forehead, lips, breast.

POSTURE

First begins on the second step near the book, then returns by the rehearsed route. Second remains clear until First passes.

Both are standing. First has moved the Missal to the Gospel side.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
12	PRIEST AGAIN <i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	BOTH Et cum spiritu tuo.
16	PRIEST <i>Sequentia sancti Evangelii secundum Matthaeum.</i>	BOTH Gloria tibi, Domine. SAY IT GLOH-ree-ah TEE-bee, DOH-mee-neh
17	PRIEST <i>Relinque ibi munus tuum ante altare, et vade prius reconciliari fratri tuo: et tunc veniens offeres munus tuum.</i>	BOTH Laus tibi, Christe. SAY IT lows TEE-bee, KREES-teh

READINGS

AFTER THE GOSPEL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 13

TRAINER

SERMON

Fix the actual seating place and return signal before rehearsal. Keep First and Second together.

CREED

This core model keeps both kneeling. Teach the appointed reverence at *Et incarnatus est* live; it is not pictured.

NO WORDS

Neither branch adds a short server response.

After *Laus tibi, Christe*, follow the branch for this Mass. Then prepare for the Offertory.

1	WHO BOTH DO: If there is a sermon: follow the trained route. HOW / FINISH: Go together to the place fixed by the trainer and sit. At the signal, return together and kneel at the normal places.
2	WHO BOTH DO: If the Creed is appointed: kneel. HOW / FINISH: Keep hands joined, follow the priest’s bows, and make the locally taught reverence at <i>Et incarnatus est</i> . Add no response.

AFTER EITHER BRANCH

Whether or not there was a sermon, and whether or not the Creed is appointed, return to the normal places, kneel together, and watch for the priest to begin the Offertory.

ANSWER AND SERVE THE CRUETS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 14

TRAINER

OREMUS

There is no server response after the priest's Offertory *Oremus*.

CUE

Rise after the priest removes the chalice veil and puts it at the altar place rehearsed with him. Neither acolyte handles it.

CRUETS

First presents wine first; Second presents water second. The 1962 rite appoints the cruet kisses; practise them without touching the spout.

HANDOFF

Each acolyte receives the same cruet back before the pair bows and turns inward.

Answer the greeting and bow the head at *Oremus*. Remain kneeling until the priest removes the chalice veil. Then rise, meet at the centre, make the taught reverence, and go together to the credence.

TRAINER / PRIEST	SERVER
12 PRIEST AGAIN <i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	BOTH Et cum spiritu tuo.
MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA	



Second step, inside the altar edges: First carries wine. Second carries water. Bow together before and after.

1	WHO FIRST DO: Present the wine. HOW / FINISH: Offer the handle to the priest. Receive the wine cruet back and hold it safely.
2	WHO SECOND DO: Present the water. HOW / FINISH: Offer the handle after the priest returns the wine. Receive the water cruet back.
3	WHO BOTH DO: Return together. HOW / FINISH: Bow, turn inward, descend, and reset at the credence for the Lavabo.

SERVE THE LAVABO

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 15

TRAINER

PLACES

This time the pair stands outside the Epistle edge, still on the second step.

POUR

Second pours a small, controlled stream over the priest's fingers into the bowl.

BELL

After resetting, First takes the bell. Carry it level and place it silently on the second step at the normal place.

First takes the towel. Second keeps the water and takes the bowl.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



Second step, outside the altar edge: Second pours over the priest's fingers; First presents the open towel.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Bow before and after.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Return the items to the credence. Replace the cruet stoppers loosely for the later ablutions.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: Take the bell.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Both return to the foot, make the taught reverence, go to the normal places, and kneel. First sets the bell silently on the second step in front of him.</p> |

ANSWER ORATE, FRATRES

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 16

TRAINER

CUE

Wait until the priest has completed *Orate, fratres* and turned back to the altar.

WORD

The server says *de manibus tuis*. The priest’s exceptional self-answer *meis* is not a server form.

PLACE

Both remain kneeling at the normal places.

After the Lavabo, both are kneeling at the normal places. Listen through the priest’s complete invitation before answering.

TRAINER / PRIEST

18 PRIEST
Orate, fratres: ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.

SERVER

BOTH
Suscipiat Dominus sacrificium de manibus tuis ad laudem et gloriam nominis sui, ad utilitatem quoque nostram, totiusque Ecclesiae suae sanctae.
SAY IT
soo-SHEE-pee-aht DOH-mee-noos
sah-kree-FEE-chee-oom deh
MAH-nee-boos TOO-ees ahd
LOW-dehm eht GLOH-ree-ahm
NOH-mee-nees SOO-ee, ahd
oo-tee-lee-TAH-tehm KWOH-kweh
NOHS-trahm, TOH-tsee-oos-kweh
ehk-KLEH-see-eh SOO-eh SAHNK-teh

ANSWER THE PREFACE DIALOGUE

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 17

TRAINER

STAGE

The Preface dialogue leads directly into the Canon, so it is kept in this learner stage.

BOW

Both make a simple head bow when the priest says *Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro.*

VOICE

All four responses are spoken by Both in this two-server Low-Mass model.

Both kneel at the normal places. First has placed the bell safely on the second step in front of him.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
08	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Per omnia saecula saeculorum.</i>	Amen.
12	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	Et cum spiritu tuo.
19	PRIEST	BOTH
	<i>Sursum corda.</i>	Habemus ad Dominum.
		SAY IT
		ah-BEH-moos ahd DOH-mee-noom
20	PRIEST	BOTH
	<i>Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro.</i>	Dignum et iustum est.
		SAY IT
		DEE-nyoom eht YOOS-toom ehst

FOLLOW THE BELL PLAN

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 18

TRAINER

PATTERN

This teaching model uses three clear Sanctus rings, one warning ring, and three distinct rings at each elevation.

LOCAL

The Missal permits continuous elevation ringing. Use only the pattern selected by the priest for the actual church.

PICKUP

Lift and set down the bell silently. Let the sound fade before moving it.

First handles the bell. Second watches First's movement cue. Both remain kneeling until the warning ring is complete.

OUR REHEARSED MODEL: Use only the priest's selected bell pattern. This guide uses three Sanctus rings, one warning, and three distinct rings at each elevation.



The bell rests on the **second step** in front of First. Second never reaches across First for it.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: At <i>Sanctus</i>: three clear rings.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Set the bell down quietly. Both remain kneeling at the normal places.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: Shortly before the Consecration: one warning ring.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Use the priest's hands extended over the offerings as the rehearsed visual cue.</p> |
| 3 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Rise and ascend the short way.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Kneel on the predella, one on each side and slightly behind the priest. First carries the bell.</p> |

ASSIST AT THE ELEVATIONS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 19

TRAINER

NO PICTURED GENUFLECTION

The diagram shows only the stable kneeling position. Teach the bows and the priest’s reverences live.

CHASUBLE

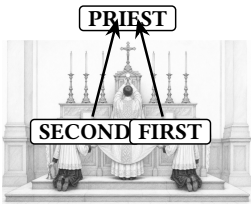
Each acolyte lifts only the lower rear edge nearest him and releases it as the sacred species is lowered.

BELL

First gives three distinct rings at the Host elevation and three at the Chalice elevation.

Both kneel on the predella. The diagram shows where to remain, not every movement made by the priest.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



Second kneels picture-left; First kneels picture-right with the bell. Both are on the **predella**.

- 1

WHO BOTH

DO: At the Host elevation.

HOW / FINISH: Lift the lower chasuble edges. First rings three distinct times. Release the chasuble as the Host is lowered.
- 2

WHO BOTH

DO: Repeat at the Chalice elevation.

HOW / FINISH: Lift, ring three, release, and remain still until the priest’s final reverence is complete.
- 3

WHO BOTH

DO: Return to the normal places.

HOW / FINISH: Rise, face inward, descend the short way, make the taught reverence at the foot, and kneel on the first step. First carries the bell without ringing it.

ANSWER AFTER THE CANON

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 20

TRAINER

QUIET AMEN

After *Sed libera nos a malo*, the next quiet Amen belongs to the priest. Do not add one.

AGNUS DEI

There is no short server response. Both remain kneeling and make the gestures taught for its three petitions.

PAX

An actual pax-instrument branch is not part of this core route; train it separately if appointed.

Both are kneeling at the normal places. The familiar Amen and greeting responses return.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
08	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Per omnia saecula saeculorum.</i>	Amen.
21	PRIEST	BOTH
	<i>Et ne nos inducas in tentationem.</i>	Sed libera nos a malo.
		SAY IT
		seh-d LEE-beh-rah nohs ah MAH-loh
08	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Per omnia saecula saeculorum.</i>	Amen.
12	PRIEST	BOTH
AGAIN	<i>Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum.</i>	Et cum spiritu tuo.

FOLLOW THE COMMUNION BRANCH

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 21

TRAINER

1962 CORRECTION

Do not insert a second Confiteor, Misereatur, or Indulgentiam before the people's Communion.

WARNING

If the faithful will receive, this model rings once after each of the priest's three *Domine non sum dignus*.

PLATE BEARER

In this model, First alone handles the Communion plate. First sets down the bell before taking it; Second never receives it.

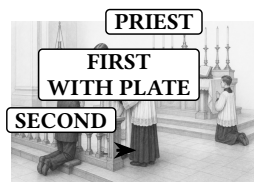
AFTER COMMUNION

First gives the plate to the priest for purification. It stays at the altar until the final wine and water.

There are no server words at the priest's *Domine non sum dignus*, at *Ecce Agnus Dei*, or at the formula used to give Communion.

OUR REHEARSED MODEL: If Communion is given, this guide assigns First the plate and three warning rings. The priest or trainer must mark the side and lane.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: At the Agnus Dei: remain kneeling.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Make the taught bow and the three breast strikes at the three petitions. Add no response.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: If the faithful will receive: ring three times.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Ring once after each of the priest's three <i>Domine non sum dignus</i>. If nobody will receive, omit this Communion warning. Set the bell down silently.</p> |
| 3 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: If the faithful will receive: rise and take the Communion plate.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Take it from the credence. Join the priest on the side marked by the trainer. Keep the plate level and under each communicant's chin. If nobody will receive, leave the plate at the credence and remain in place.</p> |



MODEL SHOWN: priest's right, picture-left. Use the side and lane marked at the actual church. First follows with the plate; Second remains clear. After the last communicant, First gives the plate to the priest. The priest clears it at the altar; First retrieves it after the final wine and water.

IF NOBODY RECEIVES

Leave the plate at the credence. When the priest offers the chalice for purification, continue directly to the ablutions.

SERVE THE ABLUTIONS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 22

TRAINER

CUE

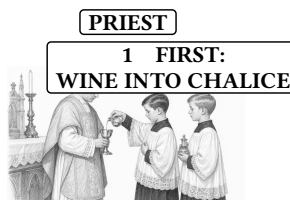
With Communion: move when the tabernacle is closed.
Without Communion: move when the priest offers the chalice.

ORDER

First gives the first wine purification on the predella, then returns to the second step. At the finger washing, First pours wine and Second pours water. Each returns his own cruet. First then returns any used plate; Second waits at the Gospel-side foot.

Both meet at the centre, make the taught reverence, and go to the credence. In this model First takes wine and Second takes water. The priest or trainer fixes the exact standing points and pouring signals.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



TWO MOMENTS: First gives wine into the chalice from the marked predella point, then returns. For the finger washing, both use the marked second-step points: First wine, Second water.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | <p>WHO FIRST</p> <p>DO: Pour wine into the chalice.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Stop when the priest raises the chalice. Return to the second step.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Wash the priest's fingers.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: First pours wine; Second pours water. Stop at the priest's signal.</p> |
| 3 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Reset, then take your next place.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Each returns his own cruet. Second waits at the Gospel-side foot. If Communion was given, First waits for the priest's signal, returns the cleared plate level to the credence, then returns to the Epistle normal place and kneels.</p> |

RETURN THE MISSAL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 23

TRAINER

ORDER

Second waits at the Gospel-side foot. Begin the book route only after First has returned any used plate and reached his normal place.

BOOK STATE

The Missal ends straight on the Epistle side, as at the Introit.

CHALICE

The priest uses the loose veil kept at his declared altar place to reassemble, cover, and centre the chalice. Neither acolyte handles the veil or chalice.

In this guide, First kneels at the Epistle normal place while Second waits at the Gospel-side foot and returns the Missal. The priest prepares and centres his covered chalice at the same time. Fix the exact centre reverence and lanes at the actual altar.



Second takes the Missal from the Gospel side and places it **straight on the Epistle side**. First has returned to the Epistle-side normal place and stays clear. At the same time, the priest remains at the altar and prepares the chalice; Second never handles it or its veil.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | <p>WHO SECOND</p> <p>DO: Wait for a clear route.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Begin only after First has returned any used plate and reached his normal place.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO SECOND</p> <p>DO: Return the Missal.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Take the Missal and stand with a secure two-handed grip. Descend the short way, make the taught centre reverence, and place it straight on the Epistle side.</p> |
| 3 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Finish at the normal places.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: First remains in place. Second descends by the long way and kneels at the Gospel-side normal place.</p> |

POSTCOMMUNION AND DISMISSAL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 24

TRAINER

PRAYER OVER PEOPLE

At ferial Masses of Lent and Passiontide when appointed, both bow the head at *Humiliate capita vestra Deo* and answer Amen at the prayer ending.

EASTER

Card 22 is only for a Mass of the season within the Easter octave.

PROCESSION

If *Benedicamus Domino* announces a following liturgical procession, there is no blessing or Last Gospel; hand off to that procession's separate sheet.

Both kneel at the normal places. Use the familiar responses unless the Easter-octave dismissal changes the words.

LENTEN PRAYER OVER THE PEOPLE, WHEN APPOINTED

Bow the head at *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*; answer Amen at the prayer's audible ending, then continue to the dismissal.

TRAINER / PRIEST

SERVER

12 PRIEST

AGAIN

Dominus vobiscum.

BOTH

Et cum spiritu tuo.

08 PRIEST

AGAIN

Per omnia saecula saeculorum.

BOTH

Amen.

12 PRIEST

AGAIN

Dominus vobiscum.

BOTH

Et cum spiritu tuo.

OUTSIDE THE EASTER OCTAVE

Use the ordinary dismissal below.

15 PRIEST

AGAIN

Ite, missa est.

BOTH

Deo gratias.

MASS OF THE SEASON WITHIN THE EASTER OCTAVE

Use response 22 below instead of the ordinary dismissal.

22 PRIEST

Ite, missa est, alleluia, alleluia.

BOTH

Deo gratias, alleluia, alleluia.

SAY IT

DEH-oh GRAH-tsee-ahs,

ahl-leh-LOO-yah, ahl-leh-LOO-yah

IF THE DISMISSAL IS *BENEDICAMUS DOMINO*

Give its appointed response. If it announces a following liturgical procession, do not continue to the blessing or Last Gospel here; follow the separate procession route.

BLESSING AND LAST GOSPEL

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 25

TRAINER

BLESSING

Both bow at *Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus*, sign with the blessing, answer Amen, then stand.

LAST GOSPEL

First angles toward the priest. Second faces the altar. Both make the three small crosses at the title.

OMISSION

At the third Mass of Christmas and any other appointed omission, leave out all three Last-Gospel responses.

Both remain kneeling for the blessing. Stand immediately after its Amen for the Last Gospel.

IF THE LAST GOSPEL IS OMITTED

After the blessing, omit all three Last-Gospel responses and follow the trained exit route.

TRAINER / PRIEST		SERVER
08	PRIEST AGAIN <i>Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus: Pater, et Filius, et Spiritus Sanctus.</i>	BOTH Amen.
12	PRIEST AGAIN <i>Dominus vobiscum.</i>	BOTH Et cum spiritu tuo.
16	PRIEST AGAIN <i>Initium sancti Evangelii secundum Ioannem.</i>	BOTH Gloria tibi, Domine.
15	PRIEST AGAIN <i>Et Verbum caro factum est, et habitavit in nobis: et vidimus gloriam eius, gloriam quasi Unigeniti a Patre, plenum gratiae et veritatis.</i>	BOTH Deo gratias.

FACE THE GOSPEL, THEN RECESS

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 26

TRAINER

ET VERBUM

Teach the appointed reverence at *Et Verbum caro factum est* live; it is not pictured.

EXIT OBJECTS

After the Last Gospel the priest takes his chalice. If used, First retrieves the biretta and presents it after the final reverence.

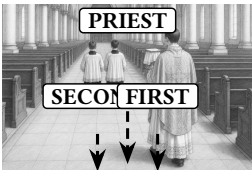
OUTSIDE MASS

The Leonine prayers are after Low Mass and are not inserted into this Order. Use a separate local sheet if they are said.

During the Last Gospel, First faces the priest at the Gospel side. Second faces the altar. The priest’s covered chalice remains at the centre.



At the final *Deo gratias*, both meet at the foot and leave the centre clear. The priest takes his covered chalice.



Make the final reverence taught for this altar. Turn inward and recess shoulder to shoulder before the priest, who carries the chalice: First picture-right, Second picture-left.

APPENDIX

PREPARE AND MAP YOUR CHURCH

TRAINER

FIRST PRACTICE

Walk the complete route empty-handed. Add the words. Add cold objects only after the route is calm.

NAMES

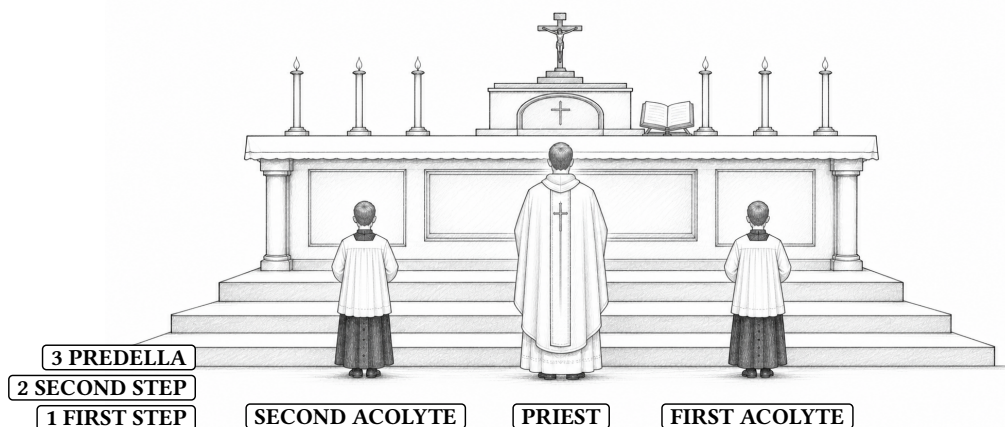
Use First Acolyte, Second Acolyte, and Both consistently throughout rehearsal.

SAFETY

A responsible adult controls candles, unfamiliar steps, sacred vessels, and every Communion-plate rehearsal.

Complete this page with the priest or trainer before practising with objects. Every picture is a front view from the nave; the real steps, distances, and Communion lane may differ.

MODEL ALTAR: 1 FIRST STEP · 2 SECOND STEP · 3 PREDELLA



Opening position: First stands on the priest's right (picture-right); Second stands on his left (picture-left). Leave the centre open.

1

WHO BOTH

DO: Point to every working place.

HOW / FINISH: Doorway; foot; normal places; credence; both Missal corners; Communion lane. Ask before touching anything unfamiliar.

2

WHO TRAINER

DO: Record the local choices.

HOW / FINISH: Centre reverence: _____ Communion side: _____ bell pattern: _____.

ROLE SUMMARY

First begins on the Epistle side and handles the bell, wine, towel, Communion plate, and Epistle-to-Gospel Missal move. Second begins on the Gospel side and handles the water, bowl, and Gospel-to-Epistle Missal move.

REHEARSAL CHECKLIST

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 28

TRAINER

METHOD

Run each item until both acolytes can complete it calmly. Stop and reset after a missed cue rather than rushing onward.

OBJECTS

Use cold practice objects until handoffs and lanes are reliable.

These checks gather the practice tests outside the sacristy-to-sacristy route.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Entrance and opening.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Walk entrance, stop, reverence, wait, kneel, and answer from <i>Introibo</i> through the move to the normal places. Both finish together and leave the centre open.</p> |
| 2 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Readings and Offertory.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Run the Missal move, Gospel stations, cruets, Lavabo, bell pickup, and <i>Orate, fratres</i> response. Every object finishes at its named place.</p> |
| 3 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Canon.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: With an empty bell, run warning, ascent, both elevations, and return. No one crosses behind the priest or rings while walking.</p> |
| 4 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Communion.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Run both branches. When Communion is given, First finishes the plate before Second begins the book route.</p> |
| 5 | <p>WHO BOTH</p> <p>DO: Ending.</p> <p>HOW / FINISH: Run dismissal, blessing, Last Gospel, final reverence, and recession. Repeat the no-Last-Gospel branch separately.</p> |

SCOPE, QUALIFICATIONS, AND SOURCES

MATCHES CHILD PAGE 29

TRAINER

USE

This training aid does not replace the Missal, the priest’s direction, or the rehearsed customs of the actual church.

FLASH CARDS

Print the paired flash cards on letter paper at 100 percent, two-sided, flipped on the long edge. Verify one sheet for front/back alignment before cutting. Practise with the priest’s complete cue on the front and Both acolytes’ complete response on the back.

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PRINCIPAL REFERENCES

Missale Romanum (1962), especially *Ritus servandus* II–XII and General Rubrics 424–425 and 503–510; Archconfraternity of Saint Stephen, *Serving Low Mass with 2 Servers (Ac1 & Ac2)*; Charles J. Carmody, *Learning to Serve* (1961); Laurence J. O’Connell, *The Book of Ceremonies* (1943), pp. 170–174; and the 1961 *Liber Usualis* pronunciation rules.

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-27T18:33:00Z

Model: gpt-5.6-sol; effort=ultra

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